



Furball

Student Rule Book - v2

A fast, silly, tactical classroom game of animals, dice, one very important football, and fewer interruption rolls.

1. The game in one page.....	2
2. The animals.....	2
3. Turns, plays and actions.....	3
4. Movement and dodging.....	3
5. The football: picking up and scattering.....	4
6. Passing and catching.....	4
7. Tackling.....	5
8. The Ouch Table and injuries.....	5
9. Worked examples.....	6
10. Quick reference tables.....	7
11. Strategy tips.....	8

1. The game in one page

Furball v2 is a two-team sports game played on a 13 by 9 grid. Purple and Green each control five animals. The aim is to carry the football to the far scoring edge of the pitch.

Rule idea	What it means
Purple scores by...	carrying the football to column 13, the far right edge.
Green scores by...	carrying the football to column 1, the far left edge.
Each team turn has...	3 plays. A different animal normally acts in each play.
Most rolls use...	2 dice + one animal stat. Meet or beat the target number.
Main actions are...	moving, picking up the football, passing, tackling and occasionally dodging when surrounded.
The match log...	records each important roll and explains why things happened.

Core dice rule: Roll 2 dice, add the correct stat, then compare the total with the target. Equal to or higher than the target means success.

Stat	Used for	Plain English meaning
Move	moving around the pitch	how far the animal can travel in one play
Speed	dodging only when surrounded by two or more opponents	how good the animal is at escaping when trapped by several opponents
Strength	tackling	how hard the animal hits
Skill	picking up, throwing and catching	how cleanly the animal handles the football

2. The animals

Each team has the same five animals. They are not just decorations: they play differently. The best players use each animal for the job it is good at.

Animal	Move	Speed	Str	Skill	Trait	Best use
Rabbit	6	+3	+0	+1	Sprint	Fast mover. Once per match, Sprint gives +2 Move for one play.
Fox	5	+2	+1	+3	Sneaky	Excellent ball handler. Gets an extra +1 when a dodge roll is actually required.
Bear	3	+0	+4	+0	Maul	Slow but terrifying. Adds +1 to Ouch Table rolls when it causes a big hit.
Tortoise	3	+0	+3	+0	Shell	Slow and solid. Subtracts 2 from Ouch Table rolls made against it.
Cat	5	+3	+1	+2	Nine Lives	Quick, skilful and hard to remove. If it would be Out, it becomes Knocked Out instead.

Team colours: Purple and Green use the same animals. The coloured outline around a square shows which team the animal belongs to.

Starting layout

Both teams start in a mirror-image formation. The football starts in the centre of the pitch at (7, 5). The Furball kickoff decides which team starts.

Team	Rabbit	Fox	Bear	Tortoise	Cat
Purple	(2, 7)	(3, 6)	(3, 4)	(2, 3)	(3, 2)
Green	(12, 7)	(11, 6)	(11, 4)	(12, 3)	(11, 2)

Coordinates: The match log writes positions as (column, row), with row 1 at the bottom and row 9 at the top.

3. Turns, plays and actions

A team turn gives you 3 plays. A play is one animal's chance to do something useful. Once an animal has used a play, it cannot normally act again until its team's next turn.

What happens during a play?

- Choose one normal animal from the team whose turn it is.
- Move it if you want to. Movement happens before any main action.
- If it lands on the football, it must try to pick it up.
- After moving, it may be able to pass or tackle. It can also finish its play.
- A pass or tackle ends the animal's play once the dice and consequences have been resolved.
- When the team has used all 3 plays, the turn passes to the other team.

Auto-finishing: Sometimes the game ends a play automatically. This happens when the active animal has no useful main action available, for example no adjacent opponent to tackle and no valid teammate to pass to.

Ending a turn early: A team can end its turn early. This is sometimes sensible if the remaining animals are in poor positions, or if you do not want to risk a dangerous roll.

4. Movement and dodging

Animals can move in any of the eight directions: up, down, left, right, or diagonally. Count squares like a king in chess. Animals cannot move through occupied squares.

Animal	Normal Move	Special movement note
Rabbit	6	Can use Sprint once per match for +2 Move.
Fox	5	Good balance between movement and skill.
Bear	3	Slow but dangerous once close.
Tortoise	3	Slow, tough and good at blocking.
Cat	5	Quick and skilful.

Dodging when surrounded

In v2, an animal only needs to dodge if it starts its move adjacent to two or more opposing animals. One nearby opponent is just marking you; two or more opponents means you are surrounded and must dodge to escape. Diagonal adjacency counts.

Animal escaping from 2+ opponents	Modifier used	Needed on 2 dice
Rabbit	+3 Speed	5+
Fox	+2 Speed +1 Sneaky = +3	5+
Bear	+0 Speed	8+
Tortoise	+0 Speed	8+
Cat	+3 Speed	5+

If the dodge succeeds, the animal moves to the chosen square. If it fails, the animal becomes Dazed, the play ends, and if it was carrying the football, the ball scatters. If the animal starts next to zero or one opponent, it moves normally with no dodge roll.

5. The football: picking up and scattering

The football is the object both teams are fighting over. To score, carry it to your scoring edge. If the ball is loose and an animal moves onto it, that animal must try to pick it up.

Animal picking up	Skill	Needed on 2 dice
Rabbit	+1	7+
Fox	+3	5+
Bear	+0	8+
Tortoise	+0	8+
Cat	+2	6+

Pickup result	What happens
Success	The animal becomes the carrier. If it has a valid pass or tackle available, the play continues.
Normal failure	The ball scatters up to 1 square away and the play ends.
Double 1 failure	The ball scatters up to 2 squares away. Extra embarrassing.

Scatter rules

When the ball scatters, it lands randomly near the square where the problem happened. If it lands on another animal, that animal immediately has to attempt a surprise pickup.

Surprise pickup: A surprise pickup can happen if the ball bounces to an animal, or if an animal is shoved onto the loose ball after a tackle. It does not consume an extra team play by itself.

6. Passing and catching

Only the animal carrying the football can pass. The receiver must be a normal teammate within 8 squares. Dazed, Stunned, Knocked Out and Out animals cannot receive a pass.

Pass distance uses the same square-counting method as movement: count the larger of the horizontal and vertical distance between the two animals.

Distance	Pass type	Throw target	Catch target	Scatter distance if dropped
1 square	Hand-off	No throw roll	7+	1
2-4 squares	Short pass	8+	8+	1
5-6 squares	Medium pass	9+	9+	2
7-8 squares	Long pass	10+	10+	3

Animal	Hand-off catch 7+	Short 8+	Medium 9+	Long 10+
Rabbit (+1 Skill)	6+	7+	8+	9+
Fox (+3 Skill)	4+	5+	6+	7+
Bear (+0 Skill)	7+	8+	9+	10+
Tortoise (+0 Skill)	7+	8+	9+	10+
Cat (+2 Skill)	5+	6+	7+	8+

How to use this table: For throwing, use the passer's row. For catching, use the receiver's row. Hand-off has no throw roll, so the Hand-off column only applies to the catcher.

If a receiver rolls a double 1 while trying to catch, the catch fails, the ball scatters, and the receiver becomes Dazed.

7. Tackling

Tackling is how you shove opponents out of the way. An animal can only tackle an adjacent opponent, including diagonally adjacent opponents.

Situation	Target number
Defender is not stronger than attacker	8+
Defender has higher Strength than attacker	10+

The attacker rolls 2 dice + Strength. The table below shows the natural dice total needed before adding Strength.

Attacker	vs Rabbit Str0	vs Fox Str1	vs Bear Str4	vs Tortoise Str3	vs Cat Str1
Rabbit Str0	8+	10+	10+	10+	10+
Fox Str1	7+	7+	9+	9+	7+
Bear Str4	4+	4+	4+	4+	4+
Tortoise Str3	5+	5+	7+	5+	5+
Cat Str1	7+	7+	9+	9+	7+

If the tackle succeeds

- The defender is pushed one square directly away from the attacker if that square is inside the board and empty.
- If the push square is blocked or outside the board, the defender is slammed against an obstacle and stays in place.
- If the defender was carrying the football, it pops loose and scatters from the collision square.
- If the defender is shoved onto a loose football, it immediately makes a surprise pickup attempt.
- If the hit is big enough, an Ouch Table roll happens after the push and any surprise pickup have resolved.

Big hits and the Ouch Table

A tackle triggers an Ouch Table roll if either of these happens:

- the tackle succeeds by a margin of 3 or more
- the attacker rolls a double 6

Failed tackle situation	Consequence
Normal failure	No movement. The attacker bounces off.
Double 1	The attacker becomes Dazed. If carrying the football, it scatters.
Weak attacker vs stronger defender, natural roll 4 or less	The attacker becomes Dazed. This is the “bad idea” collision.

8. The Ouch Table and injuries

The Ouch Table is only used after a big tackle hit. It decides how badly the defender is hurt.

Ouch roll: Roll 2 dice, then apply any trait modifiers. Higher is worse.

Final Ouch total	Result	Meaning
5 or less	Dazed	Misses next play opportunity, then recovers.
6 to 8	Stunned	Misses next team turn and recovers at the start of the following team turn.
9 to 11	Knocked Out	Goes to the bench and must roll 8+ to return.
12 or more	Out	Out for the rest of the match. Cat turns this into KO because of Nine Lives.

Trait	Modifier	When it applies
Bear: Maul	+1	When the Bear was the attacker that caused the Ouch roll.
Tortoise: Shell	-2	When the Tortoise is the defender being rolled for.
Cat: Nine Lives	Special	If the Cat would be Out, it becomes Knocked Out instead.

Status	Where the animal is	How it gets back
Dazed	Still on pitch	Misses its next play opportunity, then recovers.
Stunned	Still on pitch	Misses its next team turn; recovers at the start of its following team turn.
Knocked Out	Bench	At the start of its team turn, roll 2 dice. On 8+, it returns to a home-side square and counts as having acted.
Out	Bench / removed	Does not return. Cats avoid this because of Nine Lives.

9. Worked examples

Example 1: Bear tackles Rabbit

- Bear has Strength +4. Rabbit has Strength +0. Rabbit is not stronger than Bear, so the target is 8+.
- Bear rolls 2 dice +4, so Bear only needs 4+ on the dice.
- If Bear rolls 7 on the dice, the total is 11. The tackle succeeds by 3, so it also triggers an Ouch Table roll.
- Because Bear caused the Ouch roll, Maul adds +1 to the Ouch roll.

Example 2: Rabbit tries to tackle Bear

- Rabbit has Strength +0. Bear has Strength +4. Bear is stronger, so the target is 10+.
- Rabbit rolls 2 dice +0, so Rabbit needs 10+ on the dice to succeed.
- If Rabbit fails with a natural roll of 4 or less, Rabbit becomes Dazed because it has bounced off a much stronger animal.

Example 3: Cat picks up the football

- Cat has Skill +2. Pickup target is 8+.
- Cat rolls 2 dice +2, so Cat needs 6+ on the dice.
- If Cat succeeds and has a teammate within 8 squares, Cat may pass. If an opponent is adjacent, Cat may tackle. If neither is available, the play can auto-finish.

Example 4: Fox throws a Medium pass to Bear

- A Medium pass has throw target 9+ and catch target 9+.
- Fox throws with Skill +3, so Fox needs 6+ on the dice.
- If the throw succeeds, Bear must catch with Skill +0, so Bear needs 9+ on the dice.
- If Bear drops it, the ball scatters up to 2 squares from Bear.

Example 5: Defender is shoved onto the football

- A defender is tackled and pushed one square backwards.
- If that square contains the loose football, the defender immediately tries a surprise pickup.
- This does not spend one of that defender's team plays, because the defender was shoved there.
- After the surprise pickup is resolved, the original tackle either finishes or continues to the Ouch Table if it was a big hit.

Example 6: Tortoise gets hit by a big tackle

- The Ouch Table is rolled. Because the defender is Tortoise, Shell subtracts 2 from the Ouch roll.
- If the dice show 10, Shell reduces this to 8.
- An 8 on the Ouch Table means Stunned, not Knocked Out.
- This is why Tortoise is excellent for blocking lanes and protecting important squares.

Example 7: Rabbit slips past one opponent

Rabbit starts next to one opposing animal. In v2, this is only single coverage, so Rabbit does not need to dodge.

Rabbit moves straight to the chosen legal square. After moving, it may still be able to tackle, pass, pick up the ball, or finish its play.

Example 8: Fox is surrounded by two opponents

Fox starts its move next to two opposing animals. In v2, this means Fox must dodge before moving away.

Fox has Speed +2, and Sneaky adds +1 to required dodge rolls, so Fox rolls 2 dice +3. Target: 8+.

If the dodge succeeds, Fox moves normally. If it fails, Fox becomes Dazed and the play ends.

10. Quick reference tables

Animal	Use it when you need...	Be careful because...
Rabbit	speed, long movement and escaping when surrounded	it is weak in tackles
Fox	clean pickups, throws and rare but useful sneaky dodges	it is still not very strong
Bear	a brutal tackle	it is slow and poor with the ball
Tortoise	blocking and surviving hits	it is slow and poor at catching/picking up
Cat	a quick, skilful carrier that is hard to remove	it is not as good at throwing as Fox

Action	Roll	Target
Dodge	Only if starting next to 2+ opponents: 2 dice + Speed; Fox adds +1 Sneaky	8+
Pickup	2 dice + Skill	8+
Tackle	2 dice + Strength	8+ or 10+ if defender is stronger
Hand-off catch	2 dice + Skill	7+
Short pass / catch	2 dice + Skill	8+
Medium pass / catch	2 dice + Skill	9+
Long pass / catch	2 dice + Skill	10+
KO return	2 dice	8+

Event	Does the play end?
A movement with no further useful action	Yes, auto-finish.
A failed pickup	Yes.
A successful pickup with pass/tackle options	No, you may choose the next action or finish.
A pass attempt	Yes, after throw/catch/scatter is resolved.
A tackle attempt	Yes, after push, surprise pickup, Ouch Table and scatter effects are resolved.
A surprise pickup	Not by itself; it is part of another event.

Roll	Special effect
Double 1 on tackle	Attacker becomes Dazed.
Double 1 on pickup	Ball scatters further.
Double 1 on catch	Receiver becomes Dazed.
Double 6 on a successful tackle	Triggers an Ouch Table roll.
Natural 4 or less on failed weak-vs-strong tackle	Attacker becomes Dazed.

11. Strategy tips

- Use Fox and Cat for handling the football. They have the best Skill scores.
- Do not waste Bear on delicate passing plans. Bear is for making problems disappear violently.
- Use Tortoise to block lanes or protect key squares. Shell makes it harder to hurt.
- Rabbit is brilliant for reaching open space, but should avoid tackling stronger animals.
- Think before passing to Bear or Tortoise. They may catch it, but the dice are not kind.
- A short safe pass is often better than a heroic long pass into disaster.
- Ending a turn early can be clever if the remaining plays would only create danger.
- Watch the match log. It explains why each dice target was used and what happened.

Final reminder: grab the football, avoid the Bear, and try not to launch yourself into a Tortoise at full speed.